

Answer key | Spot the mistake - be the marker

Mild

1) Find the mistake

- a) The second row should be $1324 \times 20 = 26\,480$. The pupil forgot the zero, so it is only $\times 2$. Correct: **29 128**
- b) Area is measured in square units: **78 cm^2**
- c) The zero in the tens place was lost: **204**

Spicy

1) Find the mistake and put it right

- a) You cannot give half a sweet. Each child gets **81 sweets**, with 2 left over.
- b) The notch should be taken away, not added: $63 - 12 = \mathbf{51\text{ cm}^2}$

Hot

1) Mark these answers

- a) Estimate $7000 \times 26 = 182\,000$, so 136 280 is far too small. The pupil only did 6814×20 and forgot to add $6814 \times 6 = 40\,884$. Correct: **177 164**
- b) The remainder is 2, and $2 \div 5 = 0.4$, not 0.2. Correct: **1 088.4**
- c) The two answers are swapped. Perimeter **34 cm**, area **60 cm^2**

Investigate

Omar is **wrong**. For example: a times-table slip ($6 \times 8 = 46$), a forgotten carry, or a missing zero in the tens row ($40\,884 + 13\,628 = 54\,512$ instead of 177 164). Adding the rows wrongly is only one of the places a mistake can hide.